

Y'hi Ratzon

63a

Version 2

Samuel Alman
Arr. Stuart Izon

On the last Shabbat of each Jewish month we recite Birkat HaChodesh over the coming new month. The initial paragraph, Y'hi Ratzon is based on words which the Babylonian sage, Rav, included at the end of his daily Amida, as described in Berachot 16b. (This Gemara discusses various personal prayers which scholars included in their Amida, many of which have found their way into other parts of the liturgy.) Though not originally connected to Birkat HaChodesh, this prayer mentions the word "life" 11 times, corresponding to the number of times this ceremony is performed (in a non-leap year).

There is some disagreement as to whether this reading is purely protocol to tell everyone when Rosh Chodesh is, or if it reenacts the Mishnaic ritual whereby the Sanhedrin announced the new month. It is for this reason that many have the custom to stand as the witnesses did when they testified to having seen the new moon. Birkat HaChodesh is considered a serious moment of the prayer service, and accordingly the melodies used for Y'hi Ratzon are typically earnest.

One of the finest compositions is by Samuel Alman. As befits a heartfelt supplication, the melody is in the Ahava Rabba mode, unlike the following prayers Mi She'asa Nissim and Y'chad'sheihu which have a lighter tone. Whilst it can be sung unaccompanied, it does require the choral responses to truly achieve Alman's vision.

Recit.

The musical score is written for five parts: Chazzan, Melody Alto, Tenor Bass, and a Chorus consisting of Soprano (C), Alto (M), Tenor (T), and Bass (B). The key signature is three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat) and the time signature is common time (C). The Chazzan part begins with a treble clef and a key signature change from three flats to one flat (B-flat, E-flat). The lyrics for the Chazzan part are: "Y' - hi ra-tzon mi-l'-fa - ne - cha a-do-". The Melody Alto and Tenor Bass parts are written in treble and bass clefs respectively, with a key signature of three flats. They both have a fermata over the final note, which is marked with a piano (p) dynamic and the word "Ah". The Chorus part consists of four staves (C, M, A, T, B) with lyrics: "-nai e-lo-hei - - nu vei-lo - hei a - vo -". The Chorus part includes various musical notations such as slurs, ties, and a fermata over the final note. The lyrics are: "-nai e-lo-hei - - nu vei-lo - hei a - vo -".

Chazzan

Melody Alto

Tenor Bass

C.

M

A

T

B

Y' - hi ra-tzon mi-l'-fa - ne - cha a-do-

-nai e-lo-hei - - nu vei-lo - hei a - vo -

6

C. *8* *3* *3*

- tei - nu *p* she - t'cha-desh a - lei - nu et ha - cho-desh ha-zeh

M *8* *3* *p* *3*

A Ah she - t'cha-

T *8* *3* *3*

B

9

C. *8* *3* *3* *rit.*

-desh a - lei-nu et ha - cho-desh ha-zeh l'-to - va *p* v'-liv-ra-

M *8* *3* *f* *3*

A

T *8* *3* *3*

B

12

C. *8* *f* *6*

- cha v'-ti - tein la - nu cha -

M *8* *p* *sfz*

A v'-liv-ra-cha Ah

T *8* *p*

B

14

C. *8* -yim a-ru-kim_ *p* cha - yim shelsha-lom_ cha-

M *8* cha-yim a-ru-kim_ *f* cha-yim shelsha-lom_

A

T *8*

B

16

C. *8* -yim shel to - va_ cha-yim_ shel b' - ra - cha cha -

M *8* Ah

A

T *8*

B

17

C. *8* -yim_ shel par-na - sa_ *rall.* *f* cha -

M *8* shel par-na - sa_

A

T *8*

B

19 **Con fuoco**

C. *f* - yim shelchi-lutz a-tza-mot cha-yim she-yesh ba-hem yi-

M A *f* Ah cha-yim she-yesh ba-hem yi-

T B

22

C. -rat sha-ma - yim v'-yi - rat cheit cha - yim she'ein ba-hem bu-

M A -rat sha-ma - yim v'-ti - rat cheit cha - yim she'ein ba-hem bu-

T B

25

C. -sha uch-li - ma cha - yim shel

M A -sha uch-li - ma cha-yim cha-yim

T B cha-yim cha-yim

27

C. *rit.* *f*

o - - sher v'-cha-vod - - cha - yim - - she-t'-hi - -

M A *p* Ah - - Ah - -

T B

30

C. *f*

va - - nu a - ha - vat - - to-rah v'-yi - rat sha - ma -

M A Ah - -

T B

32

C. *p*

-yim *p* cha - yim - -

M A Ah - - cha - yim - - cha -

T B *p*

34

C. *f* she - yi - mo - l' - u mi - sha - lot li -

M A - yim

T B

36

C. -bei - nu l' - to - va

M A *f* she - yi - mo - l' - u mi - sha - lot li -

T B

38

C. *f* a - men *rit.* *3* se - - lah

M A *p* -bei - nu l' - to - va a - men se - - lah

T B